

SEOKJIN HONG

Overseas Sales & Market Strategy | Petrochemical Industry | Asia-Pacific & Europe

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I work at the intersection of market intelligence and commercial strategy in the petrochemical industry. As an Overseas Sales Representative at Kumho Petrochemical, I manage B2B sales and pricing strategy for Polypropylene Glycol (PPG) across Asia-Pacific and European markets — translating raw market data into actionable pricing decisions that balance margin targets with competitive positioning.

My day-to-day work involves monitoring raw material price movements (Ethylene Oxide / Propylene Oxide), pre-processing and analyzing customs trade data to identify competitor positioning shifts, and coordinating across R&D, Sales, and Production teams to align on market priorities. I take a structured, data-first approach to problem-solving — building from numbers toward decisions rather than the other way around.

Alongside my full-time role, I am developing BOOK ME UP (BMU), a calendar-based social scheduling app designed to eliminate the repetitive 'when are you free?' exchange among friends. I lead the product concept, UX direction, and beta testing preparation — applying the same execution discipline I practice in international business to a consumer product context.

I hold a BA in Russian Language & International Studies from Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, speak Korean, English, and Russian, and am a certified International Trade Specialist (Lv.1). I am open to opportunities in strategic business development, business planning, project management, overseas sales, and adjacent roles in the materials and chemicals sector.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Pricing strategy development and optimization (competitive benchmarking, cost structure, demand forecasting)
- Market intelligence and competitive analysis across Asia-Pacific and European markets
- Trade data pre-processing, refinement, and strategic insight generation from customs datasets
- Estimated P&L compilation and revenue-margin analysis
- Cross-functional coordination across R&D, Sales, and Production teams
- Anti-dumping policy monitoring and import/export trend analysis
- Product planning, UX direction, and project execution (side project: BMU)
- Trilingual communication: Korean (native), English (advanced), Russian (advanced)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Kumho Petrochemical | Overseas Sales Representative, PPG Sales Team

January 2024 – Present · Seoul, South Korea

- Designed and continuously optimized PPG sales pricing strategy through competitive benchmarking, cost structure assessment, and monthly demand forecasting — balancing revenue maximization with market penetration objectives while maintaining margin targets.
- Monitored Ethylene Oxide (EO) and Propylene Oxide (PO) price fluctuations across Asia-Pacific and European markets to inform pricing decisions and manage input cost exposure.
- Pre-processed, refined, and analyzed customs trade data to surface competitor positioning shifts, emerging market patterns, and trade policy impacts — translating findings into competitive response strategies.
- Compiled and maintained estimated P&L statements to support commercial decision-making.
- Coordinated inter-departmental meetings across R&D, Sales, and Production teams, facilitating cross-functional alignment on market priorities.
- Tracked anti-dumping policy developments and import/export trends relevant to the PPG market landscape.

Hanjin | Operation Associate

January 2023 – September 2023 · Seoul, South Korea

- Managed inbound international shipments, ensuring timely arrival and efficient domestic distribution.
- Administered Amazon Service Level Agreements (SLA) to maintain customer satisfaction standards.
- Oversaw on-site operations and field coordination to maximize workflow efficiency.
- Handled customer inquiries and complaints with a high standard of service delivery.
- Facilitated multilingual communication with stakeholders across a cross-border operational environment.

PROJECTS

BOOK ME UP (BMU) | Product Planning Lead · Side Project

2024 – Present · Personal Project (alongside full-time role)

Developing a calendar-based social scheduling app that eliminates the repetitive back-and-forth of arranging meetups — enabling users to find shared availability through a shared calendar view rather than open-ended messages.

- Leading product concept definition, core feature scoping, and UX direction.
- Managing beta testing preparation and early user feedback planning.
- Conducting privacy and data security review relevant to calendar access permissions.
- Applying structured problem-framing and execution discipline from international business to a consumer product context.

PUBLICATIONS

"Implications of the Shifting Indian Defense Market for Korea: Focusing on Indo-Russia Relations"

First Author · International Relations Research Paper · May 2021

Explored how South Korean defense industry firms benchmarked Russia's model to enter the Indian market, with a comprehensive analysis of defense capabilities and policies across India, Russia, and South Korea.

EDUCATION

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies (HUFS)

BA, Russian Language & International Studies

March 2016 – March 2023 · GPA: 4.06 / 4.5 · Academic Scholarship Recipient

Relevant coursework: Business Negotiation, Economics, Emerging Markets Business, Logistics, Language and Culture

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Languages: Korean (Native) · English (Advanced) · Russian (Advanced)

Certifications: International Trade Specialist Lv.1 · Certificate of Trade English Lv.1

Industry Skills: Pricing Strategy · Market Intelligence · Trade Data Analysis · P&L Management · Competitive Analysis · B2B Sales

Cross-functional: Stakeholder Management · Product Planning · Project Execution · UX Direction
